Cover Letter: Response to Reviewers

Submission 241

Benchmark for Crack Re-Identification in Ticket Management Systems

We thank both reviewers for their positive assessments and careful reading. Neither review requested specific changes. Their main concerns, namely the small dataset (11 test walls and 19 matchable identities), single-visit acquisition, single-annotator labels, and partial registration coverage, are the central limitations of the study and are stated in Section VIII, the Abstract, and the Conclusion. New walls, visits, and annotations could not be collected within the camera-ready period, so no experiments were re-run and all reported results are unchanged. The revision instead makes the preliminary scope of the findings clearer, as Reviewer 2 asked:

- **Claims calibrated to the evidence.** Validated F1 now "stays close to" rather than "slightly exceeds" the constant baseline; "outperform chance" is restricted to Rank-1; and statements about wall context and geometric alignment are phrased as suggestive ("suggest", "may") rather than conclusive.
- **Corrections.** The registration gate is now correctly described as retaining 36.8% of negatives (not discarding them), and the abstract's "twice" comparison is replaced by the two DIR values (0.768 and 0.429), with a note that they are computed over different candidate pools.
- **Clarifications from existing data and code.** We added the breakdown of the unclaimed annotation points, the synthetic-warp parameters, a definition of HYBRID-SKEL, and a citation for the inpainting method [39]; we also clarified the purpose of the sharpness threshold and the construction of the reference-level baselines.
- **Consistency.** Terminology was harmonized (registered pairs, valid pairs, coverage, within-visit versus cross-visit), and citations and cross-references were verified.

Reviewer 1

We thank the reviewer for the positive assessment of the problem, the dataset, and the reporting of negative results. We agree that a larger dataset and a real cross-visit evaluation would strengthen the contribution; both are the main directions for future work (Section VIII). The paper is positioned as an initial benchmark and a negative result, and the current results are not presented as cross-visit evidence.

Reviewer 2

We thank the reviewer for the assessment of the open-set protocol and of the context and geometry analyses. We agree that the small sample, single-annotator labels, limited registration coverage, and absence of cross-visit evaluation bound the generalizability of the conclusions. In line with the reviewer's condition that the preliminary nature of the findings be clearly communicated, we toned down the claims listed above and kept the point-estimate and single-visit caveats in the Abstract, Section VIII, and the Conclusion.

We thank the reviewers again for their time and feedback.

Sincerely,
The authors